

Worms and bugs

Computers don't always run smoothly. Some people spread bad code, such as worms, to damage or steal information on a computer. Programs may also stop working if there are errors in the code. These are called bugs. Anti-virus programs and "firewalls" are software that can protect computers from bad code.

Computer errors have been called bugs since 1945, when a university computer in the US was found to have a moth inside it.

Computer hackers

Hackers are people who write bad programs, called malware, to gain illegal access to a computer. They can then steal information, like passwords or personal details. They can also damage or delete important data on the computer.



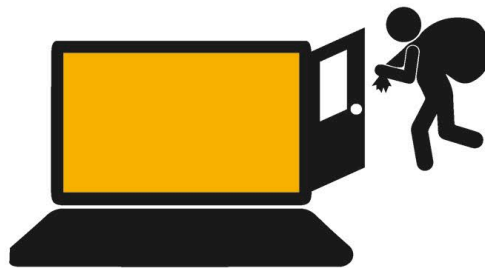
Trojan horse

A Trojan horse is a file that pretends to be harmless. Once opened, however, it loads a program that takes control of your computer.



Computer virus

A virus is a type of malware that attaches itself to a program on a computer and runs automatically, destroying files.



Backdoor programs

Backdoor programs ignore your computer's normal security and allow hackers to break in without a password.